> These poor people, when incapable of discharging the demands of their rapacious lords, are not only often deprived of the means of subsistence, but are bereft of their children, who are carried away as slaves. Thus it happens that many of the peasantry, driven to despair by so execrable a tyranny, abandon the country, and seek a more tolerable mode of existence, either in the towns, or camps; as bearers of burdens, carriers of water, or servants to horsemen. Sometimes they fly to the territories of a Raja, because there they find less oppression, and are allowed a greater degree of comfort.

The truth is that in the opinion of all scholarly works. the Tīmūrids (distorted as Moghūls) have been shown as greedy rulers. In the words of Tapan Raychaudhuri (*State and the Economy: The Mughal Empire*), 'The Mughal state was an insatiable Leviathan.'[†] If one goes through essays in *The Cambridge Economic History of India* edited by Raychaudhuri and Irfan Habib,[‡] it becomes very evident that the Tīmūrids were extortionist and an extraction machinery. They took away the entire surplus from the peasants.

As per Angus Maddison, the irrigation system was poor. He has said, '(. . .) but in the context of the economy as a whole these were unimportant and probably did not cover more than 5 percent of the cultivated land of India.'[*]

In the last years of the decade of the 1780s, Hasan Raza Khān, the chief minister of Awadh had contributed a sum of Rs 5 lakh for the construction of Hindiya Canal (Iran) which was completed in AD 1803, bringing water for Najaf. Not to forget that this was the period when the Marathas had weakened them completely, but despite that they were able arrange such a huge fund for something to be built in distant Muslim land.

Lahore-based historian Khaled Ahmed has said, 'So big was the diversion of the water from the Euphrates that the river changed course. The canal became a virtual river and transformed the arid zone between the cities of Najaf and Karbala into fertile land that attracted the Sunni Arab tribes to settle there and take to farming.'

So, while the Tīmūrids didn't build any canal in India, for their prominent stay of around three centuries, they built one that brought a complete change to the destiny of some place in Arabia. They did so in the worst of their periods when both British and Marathas were at their neck badly. It means that they were able to extract money from the subjects and that was in the 1780s when the Mughal Empire was a vassal of the Marathas, and the British had captured large swaths of its eastern territories. If it doesn't mean that the Tīmūrids were desperate to use Indian money for Muslim causes outside India, then I'm unsure of what needs to be said. I'll again quote Khaled Ahmed. He has said, 'The custodian of the seminarian complex of Najaf and the mausoleum of Caliph Ali is a Pakistani grand ayatollah, appointed to his top position in deference to the